A-A-51831A
2 February 1990
SUPERSEDING
A-A-0051831(DM)
25 February 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, COAGULATION (Malis)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers one size and type of Malis coagulation forceps suitable for cauterization of blood vessels through the application of an electric current produced by bipolar coagulator.

Salient characteristics.

General. Forceps shall be bipolar, of the Malis design, insulated, bayonet shaped and suitable for use under irrigation fluids and in a bloody surgical field. The tips of the forceps shall be tapered to a round, smooth point and when closed have an exact meeting point.

Material. Forceps shall be manufactured from Class 4 corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with ASTM Designation F899. Connector pins shall be manufactured from Class 3 corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with ASTM Designation F899.

Hardness. Finished forceps shall have a Rockwell Hardness C scale (HRC) of 38 to 47 when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation E18 or E92 whichever is applicable. Corrosion of hardness values shall be in accordance with ASTM Designation E140.

Style, design and dimensions. Forceps shall be a bayonet forceps of the Malis design. The forceps shall be 7 ± 1/2 inches in length measured as the straight distance from the outside working tips to the point where the forceps enter the insulating connector cup; excluding the length of the insulating connector cup and pins. The tips shall be 3-1/4 ± 1/4 inches in length, and 0.060 ± 0.015 inches in width at the distal end. The forceps tips shall be well rounded and shall meet exactly in closed position.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

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Connector pins shall be 0.073 + 0.010 (15 gauge BWG) in diameter and shall protrude 5/16 + 1/32 inch from the connector cup. The pins shall be 0.222 ± 0.005 inches apart (measured center-to-center).

The forceps shall be insulated with a plastic material (See Note 3) which covers the forceps except for a nominal length of 0.100 +/- 0.015 inch from the distal tip of the forceps.

Passivation. The metal parts of the forceps shall be passivated.

Tests. Forceps shall be tested for continuity from each connector pin to tip and for resistance from each pin to insulated surfaces (See Note 4).

Sterilization. The forceps shall be capable of repeated steam sterilization. Plastic used in the connector cup and insulation shall show no adverse reaction to steam sterilization.

Identification marking and labeling. Forceps shall be permanently marked with the contractor's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless." In addition, forceps of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture.

Workmanship. Forceps shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform and free from cracks, pitts, burrs, sharp edges, scale, rough areas, corrosion, grind or tool marks, and dirt or polishing materials. The forceps insulation material shall be free from blooming, blisters, fish-eyes, frosting, pits, pimples, shorts, warpage, wrinkles, and any other defects which detract from its appearance or impairs its serviceability; definitions of defects are per ASTM Designation D883.

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Each (EA). One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

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Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one forcep. Sampling shall be inspection level II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 1.0.

Examination. Forceps shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps. Sampling shall be inspection level S-1 with an AQL of 1.0.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specification, standard, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE 1: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-188-5339	FORCEPS, COAGULATION, Malis, Bipolar, Bayonet Shaped, Insulated, 7 Inch Long, 1.5 mm Wide Tip

NOTE 2: Forceps shall be suitable for use with the following National Stock Number:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-139-7942	CORD, Coagulator, Malis, Bipolar, 144 Inch.

NOTE 3: Recommend plastic material is Kynar at a thickness of 0.008 to 0.012 inch.

NOTE 4: Continuity test can be conducted by using a bipolar malis coagulator cord, NSN 6515-01-139-7942, attached to a buzzer and powered by a 9 volt battery. The forceps pins shall be plugged into the bipolar card and then the tips closed. In the closed position the buzzer shall activate.

The resistance test can be conducted by using a Hypot tester with one lead attached to an uncoated surface of the forceps and the other lead slowly ran over the insulated surface. Failure will be indicated if the leakage lamp on the Hypot tester illuminates or visible arc is observed.

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A-A-51831A

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 59952

Project No. 6515-4609

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